

Work History Summary

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Summary

I'm a mission-driven technical and business leader with more than 10 years of experience across enterprise retail, autonomous vehicles, digital transformation, software architecture, operational improvement, and team development. My background combines hands-on engineering expertise in Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js, Sitecore XM Cloud, CI/CD, and platform delivery with a broader ability to organize people, systems, vendors, and priorities around measurable outcomes.

My career has consistently placed me at the intersection of technology, operations, and business needs. I have modernized large-scale digital platforms, reduced release cycles, introduced progressive-delivery practices, created shared development standards, improved quality and deployment systems, and helped teams navigate complex organizational change. At Cracker Barrel, I served as the internal technical lead on a major digital rewrite, acting as a bridge among engineering, product, design, QA, architecture, leadership, and third-party delivery partners. My work extended beyond writing software into ownership clarity, delivery risk, release governance, technical decision-making, mentoring, and cross-functional alignment.

I also bring an entrepreneurial and operational perspective. Earlier in my career, I founded and operated a home-renovation business, managed client relationships, scoped projects, estimated costs, coordinated subcontractors, procured materials, controlled quality, and delivered profitable work. My education in Management Information Systems and Business Management, together with experience in retail operations, process analysis, sourcing, logistics, marketing, and enterprise technology, allows me to evaluate problems through both technical and commercial lenses.

My path has been shaped by grit, adaptability, and self-direction. I was a first-generation college student who worked full time and pursued education through a nontraditional path, ultimately graduating summa cum laude with a 4.0 GPA. I tend to step into unclear situations, identify patterns, create structure, and take ownership where gaps exist. I am most energized when the work has a meaningful human or business impact and when I can help a team move from ambiguity toward practical execution.

As an ENTP and iD-style communicator, I am curious, energetic, candid, and strongly oriented toward problem-solving. I naturally challenge assumptions, identify inefficiencies, and advocate for better systems. I value direct communication without blame and collaboration over competition. I am comfortable disagreeing when delivery, technical quality, customer outcomes, or organizational risk are at stake, while continuing to develop greater audience awareness and adaptability in how I communicate difficult information across technical, executive, vendor, and cross-functional settings.

I am particularly strong in systems thinking, technical leadership, process improvement, facilitation, mentorship, stakeholder alignment, and translating complex technical issues into actionable decisions. I enjoy helping capable people work together more effectively, reducing unnecessary friction, and building environments where responsibility and decision-making authority are clearly aligned.

My potential future directions include IT Director, Technical Program Manager, Engineering Manager, platform or delivery leadership, technology consulting, and business ownership or acquisition. The common thread is not a particular title. It is the opportunity to connect technology, people, operations, and strategy; create clarity in complex environments; and take meaningful responsibility for outcomes.

Timeline

- **Apr 2006 – Aug 2006:** Seasonal Sales Associate, The Home Depot | Richmond, VA
- **Gap: Sep 2006 – Mar 2009** (*2 years, 7 months*)
- **Apr 2009 – Dec 2010:** Teaching Assistant, Business Software Applications | Richmond, VA
- **Gap: Jan 2011 – Mar 2011** (*3 months*)
- **Apr 2011 – Apr 2013:** Construction Subcontractor, Falcon Fixes | Huntsville, AL
- **Aug 2012 – Dec 2012:** Student Assistant, Undergraduate Scholarships | University of Alabama | Tuscaloosa, AL
- **Jan 2013 – May 2013:** Marketing Intern, Aramark, Bama Dining Food Services | Tuscaloosa, AL
- **May 2013 – Aug 2013:** Store Management Intern, Kohl's Department Store | Huntsville, AL
- **Gap: Sep 2013 – Apr 2014** (*8 months*)
- **May 2014 – Aug 2014:** IT Process Analysis Intern, AutoZone Inc | Memphis, TN
- **Gap: Sep 2014 – Jan 2015** (*5 months*)
- **Feb 2015 – Jun 2021:** Systems Engineer, AutoZone Inc | Memphis, TN
- **Jul 2021 – Feb 2023:** Senior Software Engineer, Ghost Autonomy Inc | Mountain View, CA
- **Gap: Mar 2023 – Aug 2023** (*6 months*)
- **September 25 2023 – July 10 2026:** Senior Full Stack Developer, Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote

Complete Resume

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | Thomasjfalcon@gmail.com | [Linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon](https://www.linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon)

Professional IT Experience

Senior Full Stack Developer, September 2023 – July 2026

Cracker Barrel Old Country Stores, Inc. | Remote | Lebanon, TN

- **Technical Leadership & Platform Modernization:** Served as Cracker Barrel's internal technical lead for the modernization of its primary digital commerce platform, guiding architecture and delivery across Next.js 15, React 19, TypeScript, Sitecore XM Cloud, Vercel, and supporting APIs.
- **Platform & Domain Architecture:** Defined reusable frontend and integration patterns across loyalty, checkout, order workflows, authentication, search, and content experiences, improving consistency and maintainability across teams.
- **Delivery Transformation:** Reduced legacy website release cycles from 4–6 weeks to a predictable two-week cadence and introduced preview-based validation and feature-level releases measured in hours or days.
- **Progressive Delivery & CI/CD:** Led LaunchDarkly adoption and owned GitHub Actions and Vercel deployment workflows, decoupling deployment from release and reducing production risk.
- **Quality & Developer Experience:** Established layered testing practices using Jest and Playwright and introduced contributor documentation, component validation patterns, repository standards, and delivery guardrails.
- **Cross-Functional Delivery Leadership:** Coordinated product, design, QA, architecture, internal engineering, and external delivery partners to clarify ownership, surface risks, and align technical decisions with launch priorities.
- **Engineering Leadership:** Provided architectural oversight, code reviews, mentoring, onboarding support, and repository governance across distributed development teams.
- Introduced hybrid trunk-based development for the Rewrite initiative, enabling preview-based validation and per-feature production releases measured in hours or days.
- **Recognition & Growth:** Promoted to Senior Full Stack Developer in June 2026 after leadership recognized that your contributions and scope already reflected the expanded role.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Architected and built a unified web dashboard for managing AV fleets and operators using Nx, Next.js, and Node.js.
- Created reusable React components and utility libraries shared across all internal web products (with Storybook).
- Improved CI efficiency by 3x by overhauling the build system (Nx, Node.js, Jenkins, Bitbucket).
- Developed applications for configuring, testing, and monitoring autonomous vehicles, including in-vehicle telematics UIs and APIs.
- Automated AV drive reporting to eliminate manual data entry and enhance regulatory compliance.
- Enabled live configuration and monitoring from the vehicle or office, increasing test drive throughput by 10x.
 - Digitized and automated AV drive reporting process to improve telematics capture and remove manual data entry for reporting to government agencies
 - Developed in-vehicle telematics UI and API to enable vehicle configuration and live metrics
 - Enabled configuration and monitoring on the fly from AV or office, which increased the number of AV test drives per day 10x

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc | Memphis, TN | 2014 – 2021

- Co-led the rewrite of AutoZone.com (21M+ monthly users) using React and Next.js.
- Developed customer- and delivery-facing applications in React Native to manage orders, billing, and driver logistics nationwide.
- Designed and delivered a custom global sourcing platform in Dynamics 365, saving over \$2M/year.
- Conducted business process analysis and re-engineered the landed cost model for Direct Import logistics.
- Led the development of shared code libraries to improve quality and reusability across IT teams.
- Chaired and mentored cross-border hackathons, resulting in multiple enterprise project launches.

IT Process Analysis Intern

AutoZone Inc | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – Aug 2014

- Reduced reporting time by over 860 salaried hours through process improvements and training on a \$14M PeopleSoft initiative.
- Facilitated coordination between Hexaware contractors and AutoZone staff to accelerate resolution of system bugs.
- Created user process flows and supported rollout of new PeopleSoft modules.
- Participated in daily executive SCRUM meetings, reporting cutover and go-live progress.

Other Professional Experience

Store Management Intern

Kohl's Department Store | Huntsville, AL | May 2013 – Aug 2013

- Led a business analytics initiative to improve in-store credit card solicitation through targeted training and coaching programs.
- Analyzed solicitation performance across departments, identifying behavioral patterns and knowledge gaps in associate-customer interactions.
- Designed and implemented a training program for store leadership that remains in use as part of new hire onboarding.
- Increased associate comfort with credit solicitation by over **20%**, and overall solicitation effort rose **25% storewide**.
- Managed department-level operations including inventory oversight and associate-led initiatives across **\$500,000 in merchandise**.
- Collaborated with store leadership to align training outcomes with company KPIs and customer retention goals.

Marketing Intern

Aramark, Bama Dining Food Services | Tuscaloosa, AL | Jan 2013 – May 2013

- Scripted, directed, and edited a 10-minute promotional short film used by Bama Dining to increase student engagement with campus dining.
- Led planning and execution of a campus-wide promotional campaign for a new Dunkin' Donuts location, including event strategy, on-site activations, and advertising.
- Developed tailored marketing strategies to drive sales across campus dining and retail, targeting students, faculty, and staff.
- Conducted market research through surveys and product sampling to determine customer preferences and adjust promotions.
- Created product value through strategic discounts, weekly specials, and brand recognition initiatives.
- Oversaw quality control and service improvement by coordinating secret shopper visits and dining location assessments.

Student Assistant, Undergraduate Scholarships

University of Alabama | Tuscaloosa, AL | Aug 2012 – Dec 2012

- Represented the University of Alabama to prospective students and their families during campus visits and scholarship outreach events.
- Answered questions and addressed concerns related to scholarship opportunities, eligibility, and application processes.
- Updated and maintained student records to reflect changes in scholarship status with accuracy and confidentiality.
- Promoted scholarship programs by distributing materials and assisting with communication to prospective and current students.

Construction Subcontractor

Falcon Fixes | Huntsville, AL | April 2011 – April 2013

- Founded and managed a home renovation business, delivering projects on time and within budget while maintaining a high standard of quality.
- Led end-to-end project management, including client intake, scope definition, scheduling, contractor coordination, and quality control.
- Achieved over \$27,000 in gross profit in the first year by building strong client relationships and driving repeat business.

- Directed project planning, materials procurement, cost estimation, and risk management across multiple concurrent renovation efforts.

Teaching Assistant, Business Software Applications

Vocational Training Program | Richmond, VA | Apr 2009 – Dec 2010

- Supported instruction for a class of 40 students in Microsoft Office applications as part of a vocational job training program.
- Provided one-on-one assistance with assignments and reinforced key concepts through hands-on guidance.
- Delivered lessons on job search strategies, resume writing, and interview preparation to enhance career readiness.
- Maintained student attendance, tracked progress, and managed classroom materials and office inventory.

Seasonal Sales Associate

The Home Depot | Richmond, VA | Apr 2006 – Aug 2006

- Delivered outstanding customer service and consistently exceeded sales targets in a high-traffic retail environment.
- Earned the **Associate Excellence award** for “excellent service and going above and beyond,” achieving over **\$20,000 in weekend sales** and **\$50,000 in customer credit approvals** in the first month.
- Handled all phases of the customer service and sales cycle, from needs assessment to solution delivery and follow-through.
- Recognized repeatedly for customer satisfaction and ability to resolve issues efficiently and effectively.

Technical Skills

Primary Expertise

Used extensively in recent roles or led implementation efforts:

- **Frontend:** Next.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), Tailwind CSS, Sitecore XM Cloud
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, Bitbucket, GitFlow
- **Backend & APIs:** Node.js, REST APIs
- **Tooling & Testing:** Cypress, Jest, GitHub

Working Knowledge

Experience through collaboration or prior roles:

- **Frontend & UI:** React Native, TypeScript, HTML5, SCSS, Bootstrap, Enzyme
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** GitLab, Jenkins, Nx, Ansible, Artifactory
- **Cloud & Deployment:** Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Rancher, PCF, Apple Developer, App Center, Google Play, VMWare
- **Backend & APIs:** Java, Python, Scala, Postman, Swagger
- **Testing & Monitoring:** Dynatrace, Azure Application Insights
- **Additional Tools:** Gradle, Sitecore XP, Content Hub, OrderCloud, Personalize (mention if relevant separately)

Professional Skills

Technical Leadership • Business and Systems Analysis • Cross-Functional Alignment • Vendor and Partner Management • Delivery Governance • Risk Identification and Mitigation • Platform Modernization • Process Improvement • Engineering Mentorship • Stakeholder Communication • Conflict Navigation • Operational Planning • Project Scoping • Cost Awareness • Change Leadership • Customer and User Advocacy

Education

Continued Education

- Udemy

- Generative AI: Risk & Cybersecurity Masterclass (2025)
<https://www.udemy.com/certificate/UC-a7d646b6-5695-4358-b317-fb2d8a18c40a/>
- LaunchDarkly
 -

B.S. in Management Information Systems & Business Management

University of Alabama – December 2015

- Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 4.00 | First-Generation Graduate
- Specialization: Management Communications
- Honors College | Sales Specialization Track

Vocational & Continuing Education

- NCRC Gold Level – National Career Readiness Certificate
- Microsoft Office Certification – Business Software Applications (2009–2010)
- Stratford Career Institute – Business Management | Graduated with Highest Honors (2009–2011)

Academic Honors & Awards

- **President's List** – University of Alabama & Calhoun Community College
- **Outstanding Achievement** – Business Software Applications
- Completed advanced training in four vocational job titles
- **Scholarships:**
 - Alumni Graham Family Endowed
 - Betty Loomis Endowed
 - Walter A. Parrent Endowed

Leadership Experience

University of Alabama

Alpha Kappa Psi Professional Business Fraternity

- Vice President of Membership (2014–2015)
- Master of Rituals (Spring 2013)
- Pledge Class Secretary (Fall 2012)

Information Technology Society

- President (Fall 2014, Spring 2015)
- Vice President (Spring 2014)
- Director of Auxiliary Services (Fall 2013)

Other Campus Leadership

- Project Manager – MGT 497 Special Projects
- Project Manager – Culverhouse College Management Communications
- Organized a camping retreat at Paul Grist State Park to strengthen AKPsi member bonds
- Student Alumni Association – Public Relations, McAlister's Fundraiser, T-Shirt Sales

Community Involvement & Service

Alpha Kappa Psi: Organized Halloween canned food drive – collected 1,342 lbs in 4 hours

Information Technology Society: Led "Beat Auburn Beat Hunger" drive – over 4,000 lbs of food

Honors College Assembly Volunteer – West Alabama Food Bank (2012–2013)

Tornado Relief Team Lead – Huntsville, Madison, East Limestone (150+ hours, 2011)

Pre-2011 Volunteer Work (2,000+ hours):

- Community builds, park cleanup, Secret Santa program
- Our Lady Hope Nursing Home service

Special Circumstances

- First-generation college student
- Worked full-time to self-fund education
- Missed early scholarship opportunities due to lack of guidance
- Scholarship support critical to academic success
- ASD Level 1 and ADHD

Languages

Spanish

(4 years of study + daily Duolingo + 6 weeks in Spain, 3 in Mexico)

- Comprehension: 3 – Intermediate
- Reading: 3 – Intermediate
- Speaking: 3 – Intermediate
- Writing: 2 – Classroom Study
- Full Command: 2 – Classroom Study

Current Generic Resume

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | thomasjfalcon@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon

SENIOR FULL STACK DEVELOPER | TECHNICAL LEAD | PLATFORM MODERNIZATION

Senior Full Stack Developer & Technical Lead with 12 years of experience delivering enterprise applications and driving modernization. Proven success in technical leadership, cross-functional collaboration, process optimization, and AI-assisted engineering. Combines hands-on engineering depth with technical leadership, developer productivity, and cross-functional delivery across complex enterprise environments.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Technical Leadership • Full Stack Development • Developer Productivity • Platform Modernization • AI-Assisted Engineering • Stakeholder Management • Cross-Functional Delivery • Release Governance • Engineering Mentorship • CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote | September 2023 – July 2026

- Led architecture and delivery for primary digital platforms across Next.js, React, and Sitecore, ensuring high-performance enterprise standards.
- Coordinated cross-functional teams and third-party partners to manage dependencies, mitigate risks, and align execution with launch priorities.
- Modernized release workflows, reducing cycles from 6 weeks to 2 weeks and enabling feature-level deployments in hours.
- Architected progressive delivery systems using LaunchDarkly and Vercel to decouple deployments from releases and reduce production risk.
- Created AI-assisted code-review, bug-triage, and coding pipelines while establishing standards for automated testing, accessibility, performance, documentation, and repository governance.
- Mentored developers and provided architectural oversight, technical decision support, onboarding, and cross-functional facilitation across distributed teams.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Architected a unified autonomous-vehicle management platform for telemetry and fleet operations using Next.js and Node.js.
- Created reusable component and utility libraries shared across internal web products, improving consistency and reducing duplicate implementation work.
- Optimized CI/CD performance by 3× through build system redesign, significantly accelerating engineering velocity.
- Built and integrated Python pose-estimation models for real-time AV telemetry; automated drive reporting and live vehicle configuration, increasing test-drive throughput by 10× while improving regulatory reporting.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – June 2021

- Co-led modernization of high-traffic e-commerce platform serving 21M+ monthly users via React and Next.js.
- Developed customer, commercial, and delivery applications in React Native to support orders, billing, and driver logistics nationwide.
- Aligned technical strategy with fiscal goals by delivering a global sourcing platform that saved \$2M+ annually.
- Led shared-library development, cross-team technical collaboration, process analysis, and hackathons that produced multiple enterprise initiatives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Frontend & Full Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, REST APIs, Tailwind CSS
- Digital Experience & Commerce: Dynamics 365, Sitecore XM Cloud, Sitecore XP, OrderCloud, Content Hub
- DevOps & Delivery: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, CI/CD, feature flags, progressive delivery, Git workflows
- Testing & Quality: Playwright, Jest, Cypress, automated testing strategy, accessibility, performance
- AI & Machine Learning: AI-assisted code review, bug triage, coding pipelines, Python pose estimation, TensorFlow, ML Kit, Jupyter
- Additional Experience: React Native, Nx, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Java, Python, Scala, Postman, Swagger

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | December 2015

Double Major • Summa Cum Laude • 4.00 GPA • First-Generation Graduate

Specific Resumes

Specific Resumes

CrackerBarrel Dev Manager Role

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | Thomas.falcon@crackerbarrel.com | [Linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon](https://www.linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon)

Senior Software Developer with 10+ years of experience delivering scalable applications and modernizing development workflows. Specializing in Next.js, React, and Node.js, with deep expertise in frontend architecture, CI/CD, and cross-functional collaboration. Known for mentoring engineers, improving release velocity, and aligning technical execution with business outcomes in fast-paced, agile environments.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer (Technical Lead)

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | September 2023 – July 2026

- Served as internal technical lead for Cracker Barrel's primary digital platforms, guiding architecture and delivery across Next.js, React, TypeScript, Vercel, Sitecore XP and XM Cloud, and supporting APIs.
- Coordinated internal engineers, product, design, QA, architecture, and third-party delivery partners to clarify ownership, manage dependencies, surface risks, and align execution with launch priorities.
- Modernized source-control, release, and deployment workflows, reducing legacy release cycles from 4–6 weeks to a predictable two-week cadence and enabling feature-level releases in hours or days.
- Led adoption of LaunchDarkly and preview-based validation to decouple deployment from release, support incremental delivery, and reduce production risk.
- Established engineering standards for code review, automated testing, accessibility, performance, documentation, and repository governance, improving quality and onboarding.
- Mentored developers and provided architectural oversight, technical decision support, and cross-functional facilitation across distributed teams.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | 2021 – 2023

- Architected and developed web applications to manage AV fleet and operators.
- Created shared web components and utility libraries for internal web products.
- Improved CI times by 3X by overhauling the build system.
- Digitized AV reporting processes, enhancing AV telematics capture and compliance with custom live streaming.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | 2014 – 2021

- Revamped AutoZone.com to support 21M users with modern technologies.
- Developed commercial and driver delivery apps, impacting nationwide operations.
- Led and developed a custom Global Sourcing platform project, saving over \$2M annually.
- Facilitated cross-team collaboration through shared libraries and hackathons.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Primary Expertise

Used extensively in recent roles or led implementation efforts:

- Frontend: Next.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), Tailwind CSS, Sitecore XM Cloud
- DevOps & CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, Bitbucket, GitFlow
- Backend & APIs: Node.js, REST APIs
- Tooling & Testing: Cypress, Jest, GitHub

Working Knowledge

Experience through collaboration or prior roles:

- Nx, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Java, Python, Scala, Jenkins, Gradle, PCF, Rancher, Enzyme, Postman, Swagger

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | Dec 2015

- Double Major | Summa Cum Laude | First Generation Graduate

HOBBIES

- Speaker at STEM programs, Mentor through Toastmasters
- Entrepreneur, Builder, DIYer, Climber, Backpacker

NVDIA Full Stack Developer AI

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | Thomas.falcon@crackerbarrel.com | [Linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon](https://www.linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon)

Senior Full Stack Developer with 10+ years of experience delivering scalable web applications and automation platforms. Strong background in frontend architecture and DevOps. Specializing in Next.js, React, Node.js, and modern CI/CD pipelines. Known for strategic impact, team mentorship, and driving technical excellence across functions.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer

Cracker Barrel Old Country Stores, Inc. | September 2023 – Present

- Serve as technical lead on Cracker Barrel's primary digital platforms, architecting and implementing core features using Next.js, Vercel, and Sitecore (XP and XM Cloud).
- Partnered with engineering leadership to introduce GitFlow branching, improve merge/release workflows, and reduce release cycles from 4–6 weeks to ~2 weeks.
- Implemented LaunchDarkly feature flags to enable safer, incremental rollouts and support agile delivery.
- Supported the transition from monolithic to incremental delivery practices, helping teams adopt agile backlog refinement and testing patterns.
- Provide peer mentorship, conduct code reviews, and advocate for quality, accessibility, and performance best practices.
- Act as repository owner, improving collaboration, deployment reliability, and onboarding for new contributors.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | 2021 – 2023

- Architected and developed web applications to manage AV fleet and operators.
- Created shared web components and utility libraries for internal web products.
- Improved CI times by 3X by overhauling the build system.
- Built and integrated pose estimation models using Python for real-time AV telemetry, sparking ongoing focus on applied machine learning and model deployment strategies.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | 2014 – 2021

- Revamped AutoZone.com to support 21M users with modern technologies.
- Developed commercial and driver delivery apps, impacting nationwide operations.
- Led and developed a custom Global Sourcing platform project, saving over \$2M annually.
- Facilitated cross-team collaboration through shared libraries and hackathons.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Primary Expertise

Used extensively in recent roles or led implementation efforts:

- Frontend: Next.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), Tailwind CSS, Sitecore XM Cloud
- DevOps & CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, Bitbucket, GitFlow
- Backend & APIs: Node.js, REST APIs
- Tooling & Testing: Cypress, Jest, GitHub

Working Knowledge

- ML Kit, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, TensorFlow, Jupyter, Python, Jenkins, Rancher, Postman

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | Dec 2015

- Double Major | Summa Cum Laude | First Generation Graduate

HOBBIES

- Speaker at STEM programs, Mentor through Toastmasters
- Entrepreneur, Builder, DIYer, Climber, Backpacker

Workforce Colorado | Technical Leadership

Thomas Falcon

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SENIOR FULL STACK DEVELOPER | TECHNICAL LEAD | PLATFORM MODERNIZATION

Senior Full Stack Developer & Tech Lead with 10+ years of experience delivering enterprise applications and driving modernization. Proven success in technical leadership, cross-functional collaboration, and process optimization. Adept at bridging engineering execution with business objectives—positioned for senior engineering and technical lead roles focused on delivery excellence.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Technical Leadership • Full Stack Development • Strategic Planning • Platform Modernization • Stakeholder Management • Cross-Functional Delivery • Vendor Coordination • Release Governance • Risk Management • Engineering Mentorship • CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer (Technical Lead; promoted from Senior Frontend Developer)

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote | September 2023 – July 2026

- Led architecture and delivery for primary digital platforms across Next.js, React, and Sitecore, ensuring high-performance enterprise standards.
- Coordinated cross-functional teams and third-party partners to manage dependencies, mitigate risks, and align execution with launch priorities.
- Modernized release workflows, reducing cycles from 6 weeks to 2 weeks and enabling feature-level deployments in hours.
- Architected progressive delivery systems using LaunchDarkly and Vercel to decouple deployments from releases and reduce production risk.
- Established engineering standards for code review, automated testing with Jest and Playwright, accessibility, performance, documentation, and repository governance.
- Mentored developers and provided architectural oversight, technical decision support, onboarding, and cross-functional facilitation across distributed teams.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Architected a unified autonomous-vehicle management platform for telemetry and fleet operations using Next.js and Node.js.
- Created reusable component and utility libraries shared across internal web products, improving consistency and reducing duplicate implementation work.
- Optimized CI/CD performance by 3× through build system redesign, significantly accelerating engineering velocity.
- Automated drive reporting and enabled live vehicle configuration and monitoring, increasing test-drive throughput by 10× while improving regulatory reporting.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – June 2021

- Co-led modernization of high-traffic e-commerce platform serving 21M+ monthly users via React and Next.js.
- Developed customer, commercial, and delivery applications in React Native to support orders, billing, and driver logistics nationwide.
- Aligned technical strategy with fiscal goals by delivering a global sourcing platform that saved \$2M+ annually.
- Led shared-library development, cross-team technical collaboration, process analysis, and hackathons that produced multiple enterprise initiatives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Frontend & Full Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, REST APIs, Tailwind CSS
- Digital Experience & Commerce: Dynamics 365, Sitecore XM Cloud, Sitecore XP, OrderCloud, Content Hub
- DevOps & Delivery: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, CI/CD, feature flags, progressive delivery, Git workflows
- Testing & Quality: Playwright, Jest, Cypress, automated testing strategy, accessibility, performance
- Additional Experience: React Native, Nx, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Java, Python, Scala, Postman, Swagger

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | December 2015

Double Major • Summa Cum Laude • 4.00 GPA • First-Generation Graduate

Caliola

Thomas Julian Falcon
Thomas.JFalcon@gmail.com
2026-07-22

Caliola Engineering Hiring Team
Caliola

Re: Director of Software Engineering Application

Dear Caliola Hiring Team,

I am excited to apply for the Director of Software Engineering role. I am a senior software engineering leader with more than a decade of experience building enterprise web platforms, leading technical delivery, modernizing engineering practices, and helping teams turn ambiguous business needs into reliable software execution.

Across my work with Cracker Barrel, Ghost, and AutoZone, I have led large-scale frontend and full-stack initiatives involving React, Next.js, Node.js, CI/CD modernization, code review, stakeholder coordination, and production delivery. I have built my career at the intersection of technical strategy and delivery accountability, specializing in the systems, processes, and team culture required to help engineering teams execute with clarity, quality, and momentum.

Caliola's mission-focused work is especially compelling to me. The opportunity to help mature a growing software organization, strengthen engineering standards, improve delivery predictability, and support secure communications products aligns strongly with the kind of leadership I want to continue building. I am particularly interested in the role's emphasis on reusable architectures, productization of funded solutions, disciplined agile execution, and responsible adoption of AI-enabled engineering practices.

While my background has been primarily in commercial enterprise technology rather than defense contracting, I bring directly transferable experience leading complex delivery efforts, coordinating across technical and non-technical stakeholders, and improving engineering systems under real operational pressure. I am a U.S. citizen and understand the role requires the ability to obtain and maintain a U.S. Government Secret clearance.

I am confident that my experience in software delivery leadership, engineering process improvement, and modern web architecture aligns directly with the requirements for this Director role, and I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can support Caliola's continued growth.

Sincerely,
Thomas Julian Falcon

Bluestaq | Senior Software Engineer

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | thomas.jfalcon@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER | FULL STACK | TECHNICAL LEAD

Senior Software Engineer and Technical Lead with 10+ years of experience building and modernizing production web platforms, operational applications, APIs, and developer tooling. Deep expertise in TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, and Node.js, with a record of owning complex features end to end, improving architecture and automated testing, mentoring engineers, and raising delivery reliability. Experienced supporting high-scale and mission-critical environments, including commerce platforms serving 21M+ monthly users and autonomous-vehicle fleet operations.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Full Stack Development • Feature & Module Ownership • Software Architecture • SPA & Component-Based UI • REST APIs • Automated Testing • Code Quality & Refactoring • Production Troubleshooting • Performance & Scalability • Technical Leadership • Engineering Mentorship • CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer (Technical Lead; promoted from Senior Frontend Developer)

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote | September 2023 – July 2026

- Led architecture and end-to-end delivery for primary digital platforms spanning Next.js, React, TypeScript, Sitecore, Vercel, and supporting APIs across loyalty, checkout, order, authentication, search, and content experiences.
- Defined reusable UI and integration patterns and evaluated tradeoffs across performance, accessibility, maintainability, delivery risk, and business priorities.
- Established engineering standards for code review, refactoring, documentation, repository governance, and layered automated testing with Jest and Playwright.
- Modernized source-control, build, and release workflows, reducing legacy release cycles from 4–6 weeks to two weeks and enabling feature-level releases in hours or days.
- Led LaunchDarkly and preview-environment adoption to decouple deployment from release, improve validation, and reduce production risk.
- Mentored developers and served as an escalation point for architecture, debugging, design decisions, onboarding, and cross-team delivery across distributed teams.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Architected and built a unified autonomous-vehicle management platform using Nx, Next.js, and Node.js, supporting fleet operations, live telemetry, configuration, and operator workflows.
- Developed in-vehicle telematics interfaces and APIs for live vehicle configuration, testing, monitoring, and regulatory reporting in an operational environment.
- Created shared React components and utility libraries used across internal products, improving consistency and reducing duplicate implementation work.
- Redesigned the Nx, Node.js, Jenkins, and Bitbucket build system to improve CI performance by 3× and accelerate engineering feedback.
- Automated drive reporting and enabled live vehicle monitoring from vehicles or offices, increasing daily test-drive throughput by 10×.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – June 2021

- Co-led modernization of AutoZone.com, a high-traffic commerce platform serving 21M+ monthly users, using React and Next.js.
- Developed customer, commercial, and delivery applications in React Native supporting orders, billing, and driver logistics nationwide.
- Designed and delivered a custom global sourcing platform that reengineered import workflows and saved more than \$2M annually.
- Led shared-library development, cross-team technical collaboration, and hackathons that produced multiple enterprise initiatives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

- Architecture & APIs: Full-stack feature delivery, SPA and component-based UI, REST APIs, service integrations, shared libraries, scalable web platforms
- Testing & Quality: Jest, Playwright, Cypress, Storybook, code review, automated testing strategy, accessibility, performance
- Cloud, Delivery & Observability: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Rancher, PCF, Dynatrace, Azure Application Insights
- Additional Experience: Nx, Bitbucket, Java, Python, Scala, Postman, Swagger, Sitecore XM Cloud, Sitecore XP, Dynamics 365
- AI & Security: Responsible use of modern AI coding tools, critical output review, proprietary-data awareness; Generative AI Risk & Cybersecurity Masterclass (2025)

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | December 2015

Double Major • Summa Cum Laude • 4.00 GPA • First-Generation Graduate

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Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | thomasjfalcon@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon

Hands-on full-stack engineer and technical leader with 12 years of experience improving how engineering teams build, learn, and ship. Led developer productivity, release modernization, AI-assisted workflows, onboarding, standards, and cross-functional programs across enterprise and high-growth environments. Combines deep SDLC fluency with operator-teacher communication to turn emerging tools and ambiguous needs into practical, measurable engineering systems.

CORE CAPABILITIES

AI Enablement • Developer Productivity • Engineering Onboarding • Technical Program Leadership • SDLC & CI/CD • Workflow Automation • Learning & Facilitation • Cross-Functional Alignment • Release Governance • Engineering Mentorship • Metrics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote | September 2023 – July 2026

- Built AI-assisted code-review, bug-triage, and coding pipelines for the development team, integrating AI into recurring engineering workflows and decision support.
- Modernized release workflows, reducing cycles from 6 weeks to 2 weeks and enabling feature-level deployments in hours.
- Architected progressive delivery systems via LaunchDarkly and Vercel to decouple deployments and reduce risk.
- Established and documented shared standards for code review, automated testing, accessibility, performance, and repository governance.
- Mentored and onboarded developers through architectural guidance, documentation, and cross-functional facilitation.
- Coordinated engineering, product, design, QA, leadership, and third-party partners to manage dependencies

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Optimized CI/CD performance by 3× through build-system redesign, significantly accelerating engineering velocity.
- Integrated machine learning pose-estimation models in Python for real-time telemetry and model-deployment workflows.
- Architected a unified management platform for telemetry and fleet operations using Next.js and Node.js.
- Created reusable component and utility libraries shared across internal products, improving consistency and reducing duplicate implementation work.
- Automated drive reporting and enabled live vehicle configuration and monitoring, increasing test-drive throughput by 10× while improving regulatory reporting.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – June 2021

- Co-led modernization of a high-traffic e-commerce platform serving 21M+ monthly users via React and Next.js.
- Developed customer, commercial, and delivery applications in React Native to support orders, billing, and driver logistics nationwide.
- Aligned technical strategy with fiscal goals by delivering a global sourcing platform that saved \$2M+ annually.
- Led shared-library development, cross-team technical collaboration, process analysis, and hackathons that produced multiple enterprise initiatives.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- AI & Machine Learning: AI-assisted code review, bug triage, coding pipelines, Python pose estimation, TensorFlow, ML Kit, Jupyter
- Developer Productivity & Delivery: GitHub Actions, Nx, Jenkins, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, CI/CD, progressive delivery, Git workflows
- Full Stack Engineering: Next.js, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, REST APIs, Tailwind CSS
- Enablement & Operations: engineering onboarding, technical documentation, standards, facilitation, mentoring, release governance, stakeholder alignment
- Additional Experience: React Native, Sitecore, Azure DevOps, Azure Functions, Java, Python, Scala, Postman, Swagger

EDUCATION

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | December 2015

Double Major • Summa Cum Laude • 4.00 GPA • First-Generation Graduate

MSG & Proposal Lab | AI Product Consultant

Thomas Falcon

Colorado Springs, CO | (650) 314-8186 | thomasjfalcon@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon](https://www.linkedin.com/in/thomasfalcon)

AI PRODUCT & FULL STACK ENGINEERING | TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE | UX SYSTEMS

Senior Full Stack Developer & Technical Lead with 12 years building reliable, accessible enterprise applications around complex workflows. Leads product architecture, UX-minded frontend engineering, integration, and delivery across Next.js, React, Node.js, and APIs. Applies AI-assisted engineering and machine-learning experience with strong review, testing, documentation, data-traceability, and release controls.

CORE CAPABILITIES

AI-Assisted Product Development • Human-in-the-Loop Workflows • UX & Interface Architecture • Full Stack Architecture • Workflow & Systems Analysis • Regulated Reporting • Stakeholder Facilitation • Release Governance • CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Developer

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store, Inc. | Remote | September 2023 – July 2026

- Led architecture and delivery for primary digital platforms across Next.js, React, and Sitecore, ensuring scalable, accessible enterprise standards.
- Defined reusable frontend and integration patterns across loyalty, checkout, order, authentication, search, and content workflows.
- Created AI-assisted code-review, bug-triage, and coding workflows within automated-testing, documentation, accessibility, performance, and repository-governance standards.
- Coordinated product, design, QA, architecture, engineering, and external partners while reducing release cycles from 4–6 weeks to two weeks through LaunchDarkly and Vercel.

Senior Software Engineer

Ghost Autonomy Inc. | Mountain View, CA | July 2021 – February 2023

- Architected a unified AV operations platform and data-rich telematics interfaces and APIs for fleet management, configuration, testing, and monitoring using Next.js and Node.js.
- Automated drive reporting for government agencies, eliminating manual entry, improving telemetry capture, and strengthening regulatory compliance.
- Built and integrated Python pose-estimation models for real-time telemetry and live vehicle monitoring, increasing daily test-drive throughput by 10x.
- Created shared React and Storybook libraries across internal products and improved CI efficiency by 3x through build-system redesign.

Systems Engineer

AutoZone Inc. | Memphis, TN | May 2014 – June 2021

- Co-led modernization of AutoZone.com, a high-traffic e-commerce platform serving 21M+ monthly users, using React and Next.js.
- Developed customer, commercial, and delivery applications in React Native for orders, billing, and nationwide driver logistics.
- Conducted business-process analysis and designed a global sourcing platform in Dynamics 365 that saved more than \$2M annually.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Product & Interface Engineering: Next.js, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, React Native, Tailwind CSS, Storybook, accessibility
- Application Architecture: Node.js, REST APIs, Nx, Sitecore XM Cloud, workflow automation, systems integration
- AI & Data: AI-assisted review, triage, and coding workflows; Python, TensorFlow, ML Kit, Jupyter; telemetry and regulated reporting
- Delivery & Quality: GitHub Actions, Vercel, LaunchDarkly, CI/CD, Playwright, Jest, Cypress, progressive delivery, release governance

EDUCATION & CONTINUED LEARNING

B.S. in Management Information Systems and Business Management

University of Alabama | December 2015 | Double Major • Summa Cum Laude • 4.00 GPA • First-Generation Graduate

Generative AI: Risk & Cybersecurity Masterclass | Udemy | 2025

LinkedIn

LinkedIn

2025-06-09

Headline

Senior Frontend Developer | Technical Lead | Systems Thinker | Neurodivergent Advocate | Builder of Scalable Web Experiences

About

I'm a senior frontend engineer and emerging technical leader who thrives at the intersection of systems, people, and scalable digital platforms. With 8+ years of experience, I've led engineering efforts in enterprise retail, autonomous vehicle systems, and large-scale web modernization—translating complex requirements into high-performance experiences that work for users and teams alike.

I specialize in technologies like **Next.js**, **Sitecore XM Cloud**, **Vercel**, and **LaunchDarkly**, and I bring deep curiosity to how architecture, DevOps, and delivery culture shape outcomes. I've helped cut release cycles in half, implemented feature flag strategies at scale, and guided teams toward agile, incremental delivery.

As a **neurodivergent advocate and systems thinker**, I'm wired to spot patterns, improve processes, and challenge inefficiencies. I communicate across boundaries—whether collaborating with product, mentoring developers, or partnering with DevOps—to bring clarity and cohesion to complex environments.

Outside of work, you'll find me **backpacking with my dog**, climbing mountains, or chasing new places with the same energy I bring to problem-solving. I believe in asking better questions, building useful things, and showing up with both grit and humor.

Let's connect if you're passionate about engineering culture, modern platforms, or navigating big changes with small, smart steps.

Appendix

Languages Ratings with Descriptions

Rating	Level	Description
1	Beginner	Limited vocabulary; can recognize common words and phrases.
2	Classroom Study	Basic understanding from academic study; limited real-world application.
3	Intermediate	Can engage in everyday conversations and understand most written materials.
4	Advanced	Comfortable communicating in professional and informal contexts; nuanced understanding.
5	Fluent	Near-native command in all areas: speaking, writing, reading, and comprehension.

Employer Info

Cracker Barrel Old Country Stores, Inc

Address: 305 Hartmann Dr, Lebanon, TN 37087

Phone: (800) 333-9566

Employee ID: 2135030

Start: September 25, 2023

End:

Salary: 139,000

Annual Bonus Target: 10%

EEID: 2135030

EE Email: thomas.falcon@crackerbarrel.com

Ghost Autonomy Inc

Address: 900 Villa Street, Mountain View, CA, 94041

Employee ID: 00010205102

Start: July 12, 2021

End: Feb 1, 2023

Salary: 215,000

EEID:

EE Email: thomas.falcon@ghostlocomotion.com

Potential Job Evaluation

How to Use

- Score each category from 1 to 5 and record concrete evidence from the job description, interviews, reviews, and conversations. Distinguish between what the company says and what its systems, incentives, and examples demonstrate.
- Use the final decision summary to compare opportunities across different paths, including technical leadership, technical program management, engineering management, consulting, and business ownership.

Core Alignment & Meaning

- Mission & Values: Does the organization's work align with values such as human impact, autonomy, fairness, learning, environmental or social benefit, or improving how people live and work?
- Product Interest: Am I genuinely curious about the product, service, customers, or problem space?
- Impact Potential: Can I connect my work to clear customer, employee, community, or business outcomes?
- Integrity of Mission: Are stated values reflected in leadership decisions, incentives, resource allocation, and treatment of employees?

Role & Strengths Fit

- Technical Fit: Does the role use or build on my experience with web platforms, Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js, architecture, CI/CD, testing, and enterprise systems?
- Systems Thinking: Will I be able to diagnose cross-functional problems, connect technical and business concerns, and improve the system rather than only execute isolated tasks?
- Delivery Leadership: Is there meaningful responsibility for roadmaps, releases, risks, dependencies, quality, or organizational execution?
- Mentorship & Facilitation: Is there room to coach others, lead discussions, clarify decisions, or help teams work together more effectively?
- Hands-On Balance: Does the expected balance of technical contribution, coordination, strategy, and people leadership fit the role I actually want?

Leadership, Scope & Career Trajectory

- Career Path: Can this role build toward IT Director, Technical Program Manager, Engineering Manager, platform or delivery leadership, technology consulting, or broader business leadership?
- Scope Growth: Can I gain responsibility for teams, programs, budgets, vendors, roadmaps, systems, or measurable business outcomes?
- Executive Exposure: Will I learn to communicate tradeoffs, risk, cost, delivery status, and recommendations to senior leaders?
- Business Acumen: Will the role deepen my understanding of finance, operations, customer value, strategy, governance, or organizational design?
- Promotion Reality: Are advancement criteria clear, supported by examples, and tied to expanded scope rather than vague promises?

Business Ownership & Operator Development

- Operator Skills: Will this opportunity strengthen skills in sales, customer acquisition, pricing, staffing, budgeting, process design, vendor management, or service delivery?

- **Economic Visibility:** Can I understand how the organization makes money, what drives costs, and how this role affects revenue, margin, retention, or risk?
- **Ownership Potential:** Could the industry, business model, or capabilities gained support future consulting, acquisition, or operation of a small business?
- **Transferability:** Would the relationships, market knowledge, systems, or management experience remain useful outside this specific employer?

Decision Rights, Accountability & Risk

- **Authority vs. Accountability:** Is decision-making authority reasonably aligned with responsibility for outcomes?
- **Ownership Clarity:** Are responsibilities, approvals, escalation paths, and success measures explicit?
- **Risk Management:** Does leadership surface risks early, make tradeoffs transparently, and protect sustainable delivery?
- **Vendor Governance:** Do internal leaders retain ownership of priorities, architecture, delivery standards, and outcomes when external partners are involved?
- **Change Management:** Are major process, tooling, or organizational changes explained, evaluated, and implemented with affected teams?
- **Failure Response:** When problems occur, does the organization seek causes and solutions, or blame individuals without examining the system?

Team & Communication Dynamics

- **Psychological Safety:** Can people raise concerns, disagree, admit uncertainty, and challenge assumptions without retaliation?
- **Direct Communication:** Is candid, respectful communication welcomed, or are difficult messages avoided until they become political?
- **Audience Awareness:** Will I receive clear, actionable feedback that helps me adapt delivery across technical, executive, vendor, and cross-functional audiences?
- **Feedback Quality:** Is feedback timely, specific, behavior-based, and connected to expectations and consequences?
- **Collaboration Model:** Does the culture reward collaboration over competition and encourage shared ownership without creating ambiguity?
- **Neurodiversity:** Are different thinking and communication styles supported through clarity, flexibility, and mutual respect?

Work Environment & Execution Model

- **Autonomy:** Will I have meaningful influence over tools, architecture, priorities, sequencing, or delivery approach?
- **Pace & Sustainability:** Is the pace challenging but sustainable, or does the organization rely on recurring emergencies and unpaid extra effort?
- **Meetings & Focus:** Is collaboration purposeful, with enough uninterrupted time for analysis and execution?
- **Remote & Schedule Fit:** Do location, travel, schedule, and flexibility support my productivity and personal responsibilities?
- **Ambiguity:** Does the organization expect proactive judgment while still providing enough context, authority, and access to make good decisions?
- **Innovation & Tech Debt:** Are experimentation, modernization, maintenance, and technical debt treated as legitimate business investments?
- **Tooling & Process Maturity:** Do tools and processes improve outcomes, or create reporting and approval overhead without clear value?

Compensation, Stability & Practical Fit

- Total Compensation: Are salary, bonus, equity, retirement, health coverage, leave, and other benefits competitive for the scope and risk?
- Financial Sustainability: Does compensation support housing, debt reduction, savings, insurance, family plans, and long-term stability?
- Organizational Health: What do hiring patterns, leadership turnover, budget decisions, vendor dependence, layoffs, and project funding indicate?
- Role Durability: Is this a funded, necessary role with clear sponsorship and a realistic mandate?
- Opportunity Cost: What am I giving up in compensation, flexibility, learning, mission alignment, or future options by accepting?

Red Flags

- Accountability without authority or ownership without decision rights.
- Repeated reorganizations, shifting priorities, or unclear sponsorship.
- Feedback requested for appearance but routinely ignored in practice.
- External vendors controlling internal priorities, architecture, or delivery without effective governance.
- Chronic overtime, emergency culture, or heroics treated as the normal operating model.
- Unclear performance standards, vague advancement promises, or consequences that are not communicated until late.
- Leadership that avoids direct decisions, discourages documented risk, or treats disagreement as disloyalty.
- Process metrics emphasized over customer value, quality, delivery outcomes, or sustainable team performance.

Decision Summary

- Best-Fit Path: Which direction does this opportunity most strongly support?
- Top Advantages: What are the three strongest reasons to pursue it?
- Material Risks: What are the three most important concerns, and can they be reduced before accepting?
- Evidence Gaps: What must I still verify through interviews, references, financial review, or written terms?
- Conditions for Success: What authority, support, compensation, flexibility, or scope would need to be explicit?
- Final Judgment: Pursue, pursue with conditions, hold for more information, or decline.
-